Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey

Los Osos, California

sclokey@studentsforliberty.org | (805) 459-2396

Dear Hazlitt Fellowship Selection Committee,

I am applying to the Hazlitt Fellowship because the strongest case for liberty is sitting untouched in the sciences — and I want to be the one who puts it on camera and on paper.

I just graduated from UC Santa Cruz with a degree in bioinformatics. My undergraduate research proved what I had already suspected: living systems operate by the same principles the Austrian economists described. Mises argued that without prices, a central planner cannot rationally allocate resources. The cell has been proving him right for four billion years — each enzyme pricing its substrate through binding affinity, ATP emerging as universal biological currency the same way money emerges in Menger's theory, not by decree but because it was the most exchangeable energy carrier. In simulation, distributed metabolic allocation retains 71% of output under stress. Centralized allocation retains 53%. The E. coli gene regulatory network tolerates removal of 37% of its nodes before fragmenting. A centralized network collapses at 2%. That is a 19-to-1 robustness ratio in favor of the architecture the liberty movement has been defending in political language for decades.

This is not ideology projected onto nature. This is nature revealing the principle.

I have spent the past year building the Living Age — a project with two arms. The first is media: a trilogy of books connecting Austrian economics, molecular biology, and the philosophy of conscience. The trilogy spans 126 chapters across three volumes. I have written and organized all of them — from "The Bones of Joseph," which maps the Mises calculation problem onto cellular metabolism, to "The Triangle That Cannot Be Divided," which argues that creating, thinking, and protecting must live whole in one person. The second arm is technology: LivingWorks, a genome design system I am developing that treats biological engineering as stewardship of living order rather than industrial control. My capstone paper, "The Living

Architecture," formalizes this framework and has been submitted for publication to Frontiers in Systems Biology.

I am also the California State Director for Students For Liberty, where I have developed an impact project proposal that connects STEM students to the philosophy of liberty through biology rather than politics. I presented this thesis at SynBioBeta — the largest synthetic biology conference in North America — and at FEE Summer Campus, where I met Anthony Rosario and shared my capstone paper.

What attracts me to the Hazlitt Fellowship specifically is the emphasis on communication. I have the research, the writing, and the cross-disciplinary framework. What I want to sharpen is the craft of making these ideas reach people who would never read an economics paper but who already understand, from their own training, that life is not a machine. Every biology student knows that centralized control in the body is called cancer. Every ecology student knows that monoculture plantations collapse while diverse forests endure. They already think in systems — they just need someone to show them that the system they study every day is the system Hayek and Mises were describing.

I am the grandson of Art Clokey, the creator of Gumby. My grandfather showed the world that clay could come alive. My father, Joe Clokey, carried that creative mission through an industry that tried to reduce living art to a product — and it cost him everything. Three generations. Three encounters with the same architecture of control. And three refusals to comply. The bones returned to dust. The promise did not. That promise is the Living Age — and the Hazlitt Fellowship is where I want to learn to carry it further.

I can commit 8–10 hours weekly and attend the November summit. I look forward to the opportunity to bring biology into the conversation about liberty.

Respectfully,

Sage Clokey

Sage Clokey

clokeyd.sage@gmail.com | (805) 459-2396 | sage-clokey.github.io | github.com/sage-clokey

OBJECTIVE

Writer, content creator, and bioinformatics researcher making the case for liberty through the lens of biology. Author of a 126-chapter trilogy connecting Austrian economics, molecular biology, and the philosophy of conscience. Seeking to develop editorial and multimedia skills to communicate what the biological record proves: that decentralized, voluntary order is not merely a political ideal — it is how life itself works.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz
B.S. in Biomolecular Engineering and Bioinformatics — Bioinformatics Concentration, 2026

Relevant Coursework: Data Science, Machine Learning, Statistical Modeling, Genomics, Systems Biology, Computational Biology, Bioethics, Applied Econometrics

WRITING & CONTENT CREATION

The Living Age Trilogy — Author | 2025–Present

- Three-volume work (126 chapters) mapping Austrian economics onto molecular biology, media mythology, and the architecture of conscience
- Covers Mises' calculation problem in cellular metabolism, Hayek's knowledge problem in gene regulatory networks, and Menger's theory of money in ATP emergence
- Includes extended media analysis (Star Wars, Lord of the Rings, Avatar, The Matrix) as modern mythology encoding the spiral-vs-block conflict

"The Living Architecture" — Capstone Research Paper | Spring 2026

- Three-layer computational analysis proving biological systems operate as free economies, not command hierarchies
- Submitted for publication to Frontiers in Systems Biology
- Key findings: 19:1 robustness ratio favoring decentralized architecture; distributed metabolic allocation retains 71% output vs. 53% centralized; FBA models miss 30% of knowledge that is structurally local

"The Bones of Joseph" — Essay | 2026

- Competition essay connecting Clokey family legacy, Austrian economics, and biblical theology
- Seeking publication

Published Essays & Drafts

- "The Distributed Intelligence of Life" — companion essay on biological decentralization
- "The Living Republic of Conscience" — declaration of voluntary republicanism
- "Isolation Is the Disease" — essay on social genomics and the knowledge problem
- "The Economy of Stewardship" — anti-usury economics through a biological lens

YouTube Channel Development — The Living Age | In Development

- Four-week content series: The True Republic, The Sagent Creed, Media Mythology, The Eight Pillars
- Bridge episodes connecting bioinformatics research to philosophy of liberty

---

LIBERTY MOVEMENT EXPERIENCE

Students for Liberty — California State Director | 2025–Present

- Lead statewide campus outreach connecting STEM students to the philosophy of liberty through biology
- Developed Living Age Impact Project proposal — cross-disciplinary program using biological science and creative media
- Organize Socratic discussion events, manage outreach pipeline across California campuses

FEE Summer Campus | July 2026

- Presented thesis connecting synthetic biology and libertarianism

SynBioBeta — Attendee & Networker | June 2026

- Largest synthetic biology conference in North America
- Connected with leaders in synbio, policy, and publishing (Drew Endy, Andrew Hessel, Senate Biotech Caucus)

Cato University — Cato Institute | Summer 2025 & February 2026

- Attended twice by competitive selection; intensive seminars on political philosophy and economics

Young Americans for Liberty — State Chair, California | 2025

- Managed statewide network of student chapters; coordinated data-driven outreach across multiple campuses

Leadership Institute — Gulf of America Cruise | Fall 2025

- Selective leadership training for emerging liberty movement leaders

RESEARCH & TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Living Systems as Decentralized Economies — BME 129C Capstone | Spring 2026

- Analyzed E. coli gene regulatory network (~4,500 interactions) proving robustness of decentralized architecture
- Modeled KEGG metabolic pathways as economic agents; computed Nash equilibrium under distributed vs. centralized allocation
- Mapped codon usage across organisms as trade friction, revealing comparative advantage patterns

The Living Republic — Political Topology via PCA

- Applied PCA to voting records of 1,091 Congressional members and 199 UN nations
- Demonstrated political space is continuous and multidimensional; published as interactive data visualization

Biology & Voluntaryism — Evolutionary Cooperation Analysis

- Interactive D3.js visualization analyzing 4-billion-year cooperation patterns in living systems

LivingWorks — Genome Design Platform | In Development

- Life-based design system treating biological engineering as stewardship of living order

---

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, R, JavaScript/React, Java, C, SQL, Bash/Shell

Data Science & ML: PCA, UMAP, clustering, OLS regression, LASSO, Random Forest, data visualization (D3.js, Chart.js, ggplot2)

Bioinformatics: Seurat, Scanpy, BLAST, UCSC Genome Browser, Bioconductor, NetworkX; single-cell RNA-seq, population genetics

Content Tools: Markdown, WeasyPrint, HTML/CSS publishing, GitHub Pages

---

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Portfolio: sage-clokey.github.io
Lineage: Grandson of Art Clokey, creator of Gumby (Premavision Studios)
Interest Areas: Science communication, editorial writing, video production, economics and biology, decentralized systems